



Dolby Media Producer Suite

Release Notes

Version 2.5
4 October 2019

1 About Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5

This documentation provides information about the Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5 release and its improvements, known issues, and installation instructions.

- [What's new in Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5](#)
- [What's new in Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.4.1](#)
- [What's new in Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.4](#)
- [What's new in Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.3.1](#)
- [What's new in Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.3](#)
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 **Important:** The Dolby Media Decoder component of the Dolby Media Producer Suite will no longer work on MacOS Catalina (10.15, expected release Autumn 2019) due to the removal of Quicktime 32-bit support. We recommend that you continue using Dolby Media Producer Suite with MacOS Mojave (10.14) or earlier qualified MacOS versions. The Dolby Encoder Client component of the Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5 is expected to work with MacOS Catalina (10.15).

We are pleased to state that an all-new suite of audio-and-video encoding, and audio-and-video QC tools are in active development, with new GUI's re-designed from the ground up for today's streaming and enduring disc-based workflows. We will announce further details closer to the release date.

1.1 What's new in Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5

Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5 includes updates for Dolby Media Encoder.

Dolby Media Encoder improvements

- Supports Interoperable Master Format Immersive Audio Bitstream (IMF IAB) (.mxf) master files as source files when encoding Dolby Atmos in all supported formats.

 **Note:** Dolby Media Encoder does not read the metadata supplied in the Dolby audio metadata chunk (.dbmd). Values that are typically supplied in the Dolby audio metadata chunk, such as LoRo/LtRt mixlevels, dsurexmod, compr1, dynrng1, downmix_type_5to2 and downmix_type_7to5, can be set manually via Dolby Media Encoder UI controls.

1.2 What's new in Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.4.1

Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.4.1 includes updates for Dolby Media Encoder.

Dolby Media Encoder improvements

- Updates encoding of Dolby TrueHD streams with Dolby Atmos for improved compatibility with older authoring tools.
- Corrects the behavior of the **Optimize Data Rate** feature for Dolby TrueHD encoding jobs.
- Disables timecode output when encoding Dolby Digital Plus streams for Online Media.

1.3 What's new in Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.4

Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.4 includes updates for Dolby Media Encoder Client, Dolby Media Encoder Server, and Dolby Media Decoder.

General improvements

- Dolby Media Producer Suite now supports MacOS High Sierra (10.13).
- Dolby Media Producer Suite now requires iLok License Manager version 5.0 or newer.

Dolby Media Encoder improvements

- Improves encoding speed with Dolby Atmos master file:
 - Up to 12% faster encoding of Dolby TrueHD with Dolby Atmos
 - Up to 30% faster encoding of Dolby Digital Plus with Dolby Atmos
 - Up to 40% faster encoding of Dolby Digital when rendering from Dolby Atmos to 5.1 with loudness measurement
 - Up to 40% faster encoding of Dolby Digital Plus when rendering from Dolby Atmos to 5.1
- Supports Audio Definition Model Broadcast Wave Format (ADM BWF) master files as source files when encoding Dolby Atmos in all supported formats.
 -  **Note:** Due to format-specific limitations, loading feature-length ADM BWF master files may typically take up to 15 seconds to load. This depends on the hard drive reading speed.
- Adds an Append Silence functionality for all supported encoding formats. This feature can be used to add silence at the end of an encoded file.
- Supports Dolby Atmos master file (.atmos) version 0.5.1, which can provide custom trim controls.
 -  **Note:** Dolby Atmos master file (.atmos) version 0.5.1 and later can contain metadata (such as binaural metadata) that is not used when encoding to Dolby Digital Plus with joint object coding content, or Dolby TrueHD formats. This metadata will be ignored when encoding to these formats in Dolby Media Producer.
- Aligns processing components with Dolby Atmos Mastering Suite v3.0, including spatial coding and object audio rendering components.
- Provides unified progress reporting instead of reporting individual processing phases, which gives better overview of the current encoding progress.

Dolby Media Decoder improvements

- Dolby Media Decoder now supports the Avid Core Audio Drivers v12.8.3 on Mac OS 10.13.

1.4 What's new in Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.3.1

Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.3.1 includes updates for Dolby Media Encoder Client and Dolby Media Encoder Server.

Dolby Media Encoder improvements

- Updates the core Dolby Digital Plus JOC (joint object coding) encoder to v1.16.1.
 - Fixes an issue where the JOC encoder made incorrect decisions about how height content should be extracted from the 5.1-channel core.
 - Provides additional enhancements to audio quality for channel-based immersive content and some object-based content.
- Fixes an issue where some objects were marked as non-active after spatial coding.

1.5 What's new in Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.3

Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.3 includes updates for Dolby Media Encoder Client, Dolby Media Encoder Server, and Dolby Media Decoder.

General improvements

- Dolby Media Producer Suite now supports MacOS Sierra (10.12).
- A new uninstaller application enables users to easily switch between versions of Dolby Media Producer Suite if needed.

Dolby Media Encoder improvements

- The **Optimize Data Rate** option provides a reduction in both average and peak data rates of 25-40% for Dolby TrueHD encoding jobs with Dolby Atmos content.
- Extends the **Optimize Data Rate** option to channel-based Dolby TrueHD content, reducing peak data rates by 25-35% and average data rates by 30-40%.
- Enables running two parallel Dolby TrueHD encoding jobs with Dolby Atmos content.
- Improves Dolby TrueHD bitstream compatibility with Blu-ray Disc authoring tools, addressing seamless branching use cases.
- Includes a new spatial coding algorithm that improves audio output quality.
- Dolby Media Encoder now automatically measures loudness for Dolby TrueHD, Dolby Digital Plus, and Dolby Digital encoding jobs, inserting the measured dialnorm value into the encoded bitstream.
 - This feature is optional for Dolby TrueHD and Dolby Digital encoding jobs.
 - For Dolby Digital Plus encoding jobs with Dolby Atmos content Dolby Media Encoder additionally inserts Intelligent Loudness metadata into the encoded bitstream.
- The behavior of the **File Position** option under **Specify Time Range to Encode > Time Range Relative to** in the **Encoder Setup > Timecode** tab has been updated. When **File Position** is selected Dolby Media Encoder ignores any Dolby Atmos master file offset or BWF timestamp and assumes the input files start at absolute 0.
- Dolby Media Encoder remembers the last selected setting of the **Specify New Output Timecode** option in the **Timecode** tab under the job editor **Encoder Setup** tab.

- The Dolby Media Encoder maintains the source .atmos master files loaded into source fields when the audio compression format is changed during job creation or job edition.
- The Dolby Media Encoder code has been refactored to a 64-bit architecture.

Dolby Media Decoder improvements

- Dolby Media Decoder now supports the Avid HD driver v12.6.1 on Mac OS X 10.10 and above.
- Updates the provided speaker calibration signal to match the calibration signal provided with the Dolby Atmos rendering and mastering workstation for home theater workflows.
- Displays information on dynamic objects and bed channels as separate entries within the metadata window. The total sum of beds and objects is provided as a Complexity Index.

1.6 Contacting Dolby

You can contact Dolby regarding this product and its supporting documentation.

For technical or product-related questions, contact DMPsupport@dolby.com.

For comments about this documentation, contact documentation@dolby.com.

2 Dolby Media Producer Suite Installation

Use the Dolby Media Producer Suite installer package provided by Dolby to install Dolby Media Producer Suite applications.

- [Installation overview](#)
- [System requirements](#)
- [Authorizing Dolby Media Producer Suite licenses on your iLok](#)
- [Installing Dolby Media Producer Suite](#)
- [Uninstalling Dolby Media Producer Suite](#)

2.1 Installation overview

The complete installation process for Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5 includes reviewing system requirements, authorizing the Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.X license on your iLok (if not authorized already), and installing the actual software packages.

Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5 installs these updated applications:

- Dolby Media Encoder Client v2.5
- Dolby Media Encoder Server v2.5
- Dolby Media Decoder v2.5

Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5 includes an uninstaller application that can be used to remove existing versions of the software from your system.

You do not need to run the uninstaller application to install Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5.



Note: Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5 does not update any other application included in older versions of Dolby Media Producer Suite. You can continue to use Dolby Media Tools applications, though they lack support for Dolby Atmos content.



Tip: Any shortcuts or quick-start icons to the default location of v1.1.x or later Dolby Media Encoder or Dolby Media Decoder applications will automatically link to updated software versions.

2.2 System requirements

Before installing Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5, you should review the minimum system requirements and compatibility information to verify that your system fully supports the release.

Minimum system requirements

Dolby Media Producer Suite has these minimum system requirements:

- Apple Mac Pro 5,1 or later (6,1 preferred)
 -  **Note:** Dolby Media Producer Suite can run on less powerful machines, but these configurations are not officially qualified.
- Intel Xeon, Intel Core i7 or Intel Core i5 with full support of the SSE4.2 instruction set (Nehalem/Westmere and later microarchitectures)
- 8 GB RAM, 1.066 MHz DDR3 or faster
 -  **Note:** 16 GB DDR4 are recommended for Dolby TrueHD encoding jobs with Dolby Atmos.
- Mac OS X 10.10, Mac OS X 10.11, or MacOS 10.12 (Sierra), or MacOS 10.13 (High Sierra)
 -  **Note:** Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.5 can also run on Apple Mac OS X 10.9, but this configuration is not officially qualified.
- 20 GB of free space per hour of source material on the system drive of the Dolby Media Encoder Server for temporary file storage
 -  **Note:** If you plan to run parallel encoding jobs, consider 40 GB of free space.
- 256 GB free space on additional drives for input and output media storage (SSD preferred)
- An installed copy of iLok License Manager version 5.0 or newer

Dolby Media Decoder audio hardware compatibility

Dolby Media Decoder has been validated on the following audio hardware:

Avid ProTools|HDX

- Pro Tools|HD MADI
- Pro Tools|HD I/O
- Mac OS X 10.10.5 — Pro Tools 12.6.1 drivers
- Mac OS X 10.11.6 — Pro Tools 12.6.1 drivers
- MacOS 10.12 — Pro Tools 12.6.1 drivers
- MacOS 10.13 — Pro Tools 12.8.3 drivers

Avid Pro Tools|HD Native

- Pro Tools|HD MADI
- Pro Tools|HD I/O
- Mac OS X 10.11.6 — Pro Tools 12.6.1 drivers

- MacOS 10.12 — Pro Tools 12.6.1 drivers
- MacOS 10.13 — Pro Tools 12.8.3 drivers

RME Fireface UFX

- Firewire 400 (driver v3.35)
- USB 2.0 (driver v3.14)
- Mac OS X 10.11.6
- MacOS 10.12
- MacOS 10.13

2.3 Authorizing Dolby Media Producer Suite licenses on your iLok

The Dolby Media Encoder Server and Dolby Media Decoder applications use Pace iLok antipiracy software. You must authorize a Dolby Media Producer Suite license stored on an iLok USB key to run these applications.

Prerequisites

Make sure that you have:

- An existing iLok account. You can find sign-up instructions at ilok.com.
- A physical iLok USB smart key (available for purchase from ilok.com and other distributors) inserted on a USB port on the computer where you plan to install Dolby Media Producer Suite.
- iLok License Manager version 5.0 or newer (available as a free download from ilok.com) installed on the computer where you plan to install Dolby Media Producer Suite.
- Authorization codes provided by your professional audio products dealer.

About this task

Your professional audio products dealer will provide you with the codes required to authorize Dolby Media Producer Suite at your location. You can install the software on multiple computers and move the iLok keys between them as needed.

Procedure

1. Launch the iLok License Manager.
2. In the **iLok License Manager** window, sign in to your account, and then click (highlight) your account name in the navigation bar.
3. Click the **Redeem License Code** navigation link at the top of the page (to the right of the search field), or select this option from the **Licenses** menu in the menu bar.
4. In the **Enter Activation Code** dialog box, copy and paste one of the license codes that were provided by Dolby.
5. In the dialog box, click **Next**.
6. In the **Select an Activation Location** dialog box, review the name of the license activation to be redeemed, and then select the iLok you have inserted into the computer as the destination for the new license.
7. Click **Activate** in the lower right-hand corner.
8. When prompted to confirm the activation and the destination iLok, click **OK**.
9. Verify that the new Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.X license activation is shown in the list for your account, and then click the bar for your iLok in the left-hand column to show the list of licenses stored on that iLok.

You should see the Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.X license in that list.

Results

Repeat the preceding steps with any additional iLoks, using the remaining authorization codes.



Note: If you intend to move the iLok keys to other computers in order to run Dolby Media Producer Suite, verify that the latest version of the iLok License Manager application is installed on those computers.

2.4 Installing Dolby Media Producer Suite

You can install Dolby Media Producer Suite on any Apple Mac OS X 10.10, OS X 10.11, or MacOS 10.12, or MacOS 10.13 computer qualified and set up for Dolby Media Producer Suite.

Prerequisites

Make sure the downloaded .zip file containing the Dolby Media Producer Suite installer package is located on your local hard drive and not on a network drive.

Procedure

1. Double-click the downloaded .zip file to extract its contents.
2. Double-click the Dolby Media Producer Suite Apple disk image file (.dmg).
3. Double-click the Dolby Media Producer Suite installer package (.pkg) to begin installation.
4. Follow the onscreen instructions to install the software.

When the **Custom Install** dialog box appears, select the applications you want to install.



Note: The Dolby Media Encoder Server is required to run as a background service on the machine on which it is installed. Any machines with Dolby Media Encoder Server installed require an iLok with the Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.X license loaded on it.

5. Verify that an iLok USB key with the licenses for Dolby Media Producer Suite is inserted on a USB port on the computer.

The license authorizes your computer to use the Dolby Media Producer Suite software applications.

What to do next

Repeat this procedure to install Dolby Media Producer Suite on any other Mac OS X or MacOS computers in your facility.

 **Note:** Five license codes are provided so that you can run Dolby Media Encoder and Dolby Media Decoder on up to five computers at a time. Each license is activated on a separate iLok. You may install the software on more computers and move the iLok keys between computers as needed.

 **Tip:** If you intend to move the iLok keys to other computers in order to run Dolby Media Producer Suite, verify that the iLok License Manager is installed on all the computers.

Refer to the *Dolby Media Encoder user's manual* and *Dolby Media Decoder user's manual* for guidance on system setup after the software has been installed. You can access the manuals selecting **Help** on the application menu bar.

2.5 Uninstalling Dolby Media Producer Suite

The Dolby Media Producer Suite package includes an uninstaller application that easily removes Dolby Media Producer Suite and its associated files from your system.

Prerequisites

Make sure the downloaded .zip file containing the Dolby Media Producer Suite installer package is located on your local hard drive and not on a network drive.

 **Note:** After installing Dolby Media Producer Suite v2.4, the uninstaller can also be found under the same folder as the Dolby Media Producer Suite applications.

Procedure

1. Double-click the downloaded .zip file to extract its contents.
2. Double-click the Dolby Media Producer Suite Apple disk image file (.dmg).
3. Double-click the Uninstall Dolby Media Producer.app file.



Uninstall Dolby Media
Producer.app

4. Follow the onscreen instructions to uninstall the software.
Uninstalling Dolby Media Producer Suite will abort any running encoding jobs.

3 Known issues

The new software has some known issues that may impact your workflow. We recommend reviewing these issues prior to using the software. Solutions are provided where applicable.

- [Known issues in Dolby Media Encoder](#)

- [Known issues in Dolby Media Decoder](#)

3.1 Known issues in Dolby Media Encoder

Dolby Media Encoder has some known issues in this release, some of which have solutions.

- Dolby Media Encoder displays activation error messages errors when it cannot recognize the iLok inserted in your computer. If this happens, launch the iLok License Manager application and verify that the license manager recognizes your iLok. [DMP-2075]
- Remote Dolby Media Encoder servers will not be accessible if the computer name assigned to that computer is written using UTF-8 or UTF-16 characters. To ensure the remote server can be accessed, use ASCII characters for the computer name. To see the computer name, select **System Preferences > Sharing**. [DMP-3331]
- There may be difficulties running encoding jobs for source or destination file or path names that use UTF-8 characters on a remote server if automounting is used. To avoid this issue, manually mount the source and destination directories to the computers running the Dolby Media Encoder Client and Dolby Media Encoder Server applications, and set up path translation entries as needed. Alternatively, run the server application locally, on the same computer as the client. [DMP-3330]
- Dolby Media Encoder works best with only one active project at a time. Occasionally, after creating and closing multiple projects in the project window, the encoder can be unable to create a new project. If this occurs, close Dolby Media Encoder, restart it, and then open the desired project. [DMP-2161]
- The **Pause** option in the encoder queue will not keep a submitted Dolby TrueHD job in the paused state if the Dolby Media Encoder Server is restarted or rebooted. The job will start running again and run to completion unless **Pause** is chosen a second time. [DMP-3320]
- In the encoder queue, attempting to remove a job that was created in a project that was closed may result in prompts for the administrator password. To avoid this, open the project file (.dpp) in which the job was created, and then delete the job from the encoder queue. [DMP-2593]
- When encoding a 5.1-channel Dolby Digital Plus signal for use as a secondary audio stream for Blu-ray Disc authoring, the **Preferred Stereo Downmix** parameter selection mechanism is not working properly. The flag will be set to **Stereo** in the bitstream even if the user control is set to **Surround**. This means that a decoder playing back this stream when set to **Auto** downmixing will use an Lo/Ro downmix, instead of an Lt/Rt downmix. This can shift the image of the rear channels as presented in a two-channel downmix. [DMP-3317]
- If an encoding job is in progress and access to the source files is lost or disconnected during the encoding process, the encoding will be interrupted, and the job log will present an error message. However, the last line of the log will incorrectly report that the job has completed, and the job list in the project window will also say that the job has completed. To avoid this issue, never disconnect disk drives and network file access during encoding. [DMP-2122]
- The encoding progress display at the bottom of the job editor window may stop updating if multiple projects are open at the same time. Encoding progress can be monitored in the job list window, as described in the *Dolby Media Encoder user's manual*. [DMP-2610]
- Hot Jobs created with versions of Dolby Media Encoder prior to v2.4 are not compatible with Dolby Media Encoder v2.5, and will need to be created again. [DMP-671]
- Hot Job encoding does not support encoding using a remote server. [DMP-3228]

- Attempting to open a Hot Job for editing from the Apple **Finder** window when the Dolby Media Encoder application is not already running can sometimes fail to start the encoder. To avoid this, start the encoder before attempting to open a Hot Job from the **Finder**. [DMP-3231]
- When a Hot Job is opened and the **Job Name** field on the **User Info** page is edited, the client creates a new Hot Job on the desktop with this new name. The old Hot Job remains unmodified in its original location. If this old Hot Job is no longer needed, delete it. [DMP-3311]

3.2 Known issues in Dolby Media Decoder

Dolby Media Decoder has some known issues in this release, some of which have solutions.

- Avid devices have been found to produce timeout errors when loading files with different sample rates than those currently set in the Avid device. If this happens, we recommend reloading the file and setting the sample rate in the Avid device to match that of the file. [DMP-3782]
- Dolby Media Decoder provides an error message if an Avid HD device is no longer accessible (for example, if it is disconnected or powered down) and you press play, or the decoder can experience instability if the device is not found. [DMP-3002]

As a workaround, perform these steps:

1. Close Dolby Media Decoder.
If the Dolby Media Decoder is hung, press the Command+Option+Escape keys, select **Dolby Media Decoder**, and click **Force Quit**.
 2. Verify that the Avid HD device is on, and that it is connected to the system.
 3. Open the Core Audio manager, and validate that the manager is connected to the device.
 4. Restart Dolby Media Decoder.
 5. Load an Avid HD configuration from the **Configurations** page in the **Preferences** window.
 6. Load an encoded file, and press play.
 7. If Dolby Media Decoder does not recognize the Avid HD device, shut down the computer and HD device, and then follow the Avid instructions for relaunching the device and the computer.
- In some cases, resizing the video playback window can cause the video image to go black. If this happens, start or restart video playback to refresh the image. [DMP-3213]